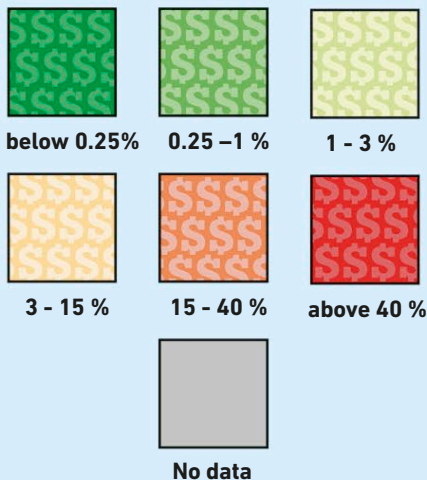


The poverty line

A poverty line is the minimum level of income thought to be enough for a person to live on. It is the least amount needed to provide basic necessities: food, clothing, health care, and shelter. The cost of living is different around the world, so the poverty line varies from country to country.

PEOPLE ON LESS THAN \$1.90 A DAY

The international extreme poverty line of \$1.90 income a day is a global measure of absolute poverty. This amount was set by the World Bank in 2015, and will be updated when necessary to reflect the cost of living. The map shows the percentage of each country's people earning less than \$1.90 a day.



Bolivia
One of the poorest countries in South America. Ambitious goals have been set surrounding the country's sanitation services, but currently only a third of Bolivia's rural population has access to proper sewage systems.

Argentina
Lower unemployment has helped drastically to reduce poverty in recent years.

US
The wealth gap is huge in America; the top 1 percent of US households hold 15 times more wealth than the entirety of the lower 50 percent.

Haiti
The most cases of extreme poverty in the western hemisphere. Haiti's economy was severely affected by a 2010 earthquake, and is still yet to recover.

Liberia
One of the poorest countries in the world. An estimated 64 percent of the population lives below the \$1.90-a-day line.

Ghana
While the overall poverty rate has gone down sharply over the last 30 years, poverty in the north of the country has changed little.

Morocco
Income inequality here is the highest in North Africa.

Poverty

The COVID-19 pandemic means that global poverty is expected to rise for the first time since 2000. Sub-Saharan Africa has by far the most cases of extreme poverty—half of the countries in this region have a poverty rate higher than 35%.

Inequality

In many countries, the gap between rich and poor is widening. Tax, special benefits for the lowest earners, and free education, among other things, can help reduce this. These charts show how much of a country's overall wealth the richest people own. The countries shown here are those with a very large gap between rich and poor, and those where the gap is less noticeable.